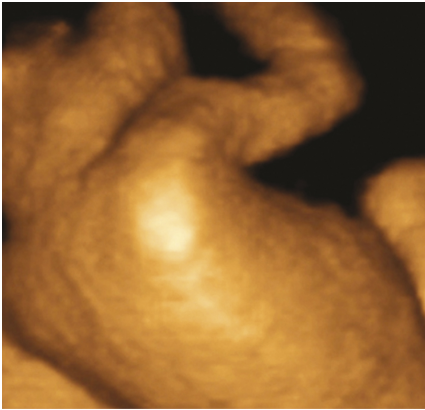




YOU ARE **27 WEEKS AND 4 DAYS**

87 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

This baby's back is turned and is facing away from the ultrasound scanner. The skin is much less transparent than before since your baby is constantly laying down fat reserves beneath it. This fat accounts, in part, for much of your baby's weight gain from now on.

“Your baby is growing eyebrows and eyelashes—and hair on their head—and making good use of all the space in your uterus.”

Your baby's eyes are now open, and both the eyebrows and the eyelashes have grown. The hair on your baby's head continues to get longer.

It's quite likely that your baby is making use of all the space available and may well be in a breech position (bottom down), at least some of the time. This is the case in a third of pregnancies at this stage, but your baby's position is unlikely to stabilize until after 36 or 37 weeks of pregnancy. Because the shape of your uterus naturally favors a head-down position, only 3 to 4 percent of babies remain in the breech position after 37 weeks. It may be quite difficult for you (and your doctor) to tell your baby's position at this stage. For example, just because the feet kick you in a particular place doesn't tell you much about your baby's position. Babies are very flexible and a scan might show that they are doubled up with their feet on their head.

PELVIC GIRDLE PAIN (PGP)

Hormonal shifts lead to changes in your bony pelvis, which can be extremely painful. You know you've got PGP when sneezing hurts, you waddle when you walk, and turning over in bed is a major task. Formerly known as SPD, or symphysis pubis dysfunction, PGP affects one in five pregnant women. Try the following if you have PGP:

- Keep your legs together when getting in and out of bed or the car (place a plastic bag on the seat to help you swivel).
- Sleep on your side with a pillow between your legs.
- Wear comfortable shoes.
- Avoid tasks that hurt.
- Relax in warm water.
- Ask your doctor for a support belt to help ease the pain.
- Studies show that physical therapy and acupuncture may help symphysis pubis dysfunction.

BLOOD TESTS
